

Lab 3.1: Design a Personal KPI Dashboard

Introduction

This hands-on lab gives you practice designing a personal sales dashboard. You will choose the five to seven metrics that matter most for a given role, decide how to lay them out, and justify each choice. The goal is to practice the discipline of selection, picking the few numbers that drive decisions rather than tracking everything you can.

Learning Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Select five to seven meaningful metrics for a defined sales role, balancing leading and lagging indicators.
- Justify each metric by the decision it informs or the result it tracks.
- Identify and exclude vanity metrics.
- Design a dashboard layout that uses visual hierarchy and appropriate update frequency.



Scenario

You are an Account Executive at PayPro Solutions. Your role focuses on three things: winning new clients, keeping existing clients (retention), and growing accounts by upselling them into benefits administration. You want a personal dashboard that helps you manage your week and see whether you are on track.

Your task is to design that dashboard: choose five to seven metrics, decide which one is most important, and write a brief justification for each.

Tools Overview

Metric Selection and Dashboard Principles

The principles from this lesson: choose five to seven metrics, use visual hierarchy so the most important number stands out, mix leading and lagging indicators, and avoid vanity metrics.

Resource Files

Lab 3.1 Exemplar Solution (DOCX)

Supporting lesson resources: Reading: Leading vs Lagging KPIs; FAQ: Which Metrics Matter Most

Note: This lab intentionally uses no dashboard template. Selecting and structuring the metrics yourself is the skill being practiced.

Activity Steps

Exercise 1: Select Your Metrics

Objective: Choose the five to seven metrics that matter most for this role.

Step 1: Brainstorm, then cut

List the metrics you could track for new business, retention, and upsells. Then cut the list down to five to seven. Make sure you include both leading indicators (activities you control) and lagging indicators (results) and leave off any vanity metrics.

Step 2: Justify each one

For each metric you keep, write one sentence explaining why it earns its place, what decision it informs, or what result it tracks.

Exercise 2: Lay Out the Dashboard

Objective: Organize the metrics using visual hierarchy.

Step 1: Choose your top metric

Decide which single metric matters most for your role. This becomes the largest, most prominent item; the first thing your eye lands on.

Step 2: Sketch the layout

Sketch or describe the layout: the top metric front and center, supporting metrics arranged around it, grouped sensibly (for example, new business together, retention together). Note the update frequency for each (daily, weekly, or monthly).

Deliverables

By the end of this lab, you should have:

- A list of five to seven metrics, each with a one-sentence justification.

- A dashboard sketch or layout description showing visual hierarchy and update frequency.

Summary

Congratulations! You have completed this lab. In this activity, you practiced selecting meaningful sales metrics, balancing leading and lagging indicators, and organizing information using visual hierarchy. This type of dashboard design is a foundational sales management skill that helps professionals focus on the metrics that drive decisions, monitor performance effectively, and take action with greater clarity and confidence.
